[LIT-POEM-008] Tangkhul Meiphung: The Wounds of Time

Translation: Hearthside Reflections on Time and Memory

Work Type: POEM | Creator: Thotdharmi Shimray | Year: 2019
Village: Ukhrul | Dialect: Standard Tangkhul | Book ID: None
Publisher / Source: Contemporary Tangkhul Writers Forum, Ukhrul
Clearance: Author Permitted | Permission: community_authorized | Status: verified

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Themes: The traditional hearth (*Meiphung*) as the sacred altar of memory and storytelling, Cultural continuity versus historical upheaval and

Structure & Meter: Contemporary reflective free verse with contemplative pauses and cycli

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Critical Overview: Authored by contemporary poet Thotdharmi Shimray. It won wide acclaim in regional literary competitions for its poignant exploration

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Indigenous Tangkhul Literary Text / Stanzas:

Meiphung-li pamlaga khangapik meikha theida kachikhangai,
Iramwui khararchan kacham-kacham ningli ngasungtatta.
Chitharan kharuikaho eina ramwui ngashan ngacheilaka,
Wounds of time thada ning-ngalungli kashak-kakhayei shoksang.

English Translation & Literary Rendering:

Sitting beside the ancestral hearth, watching the glowing embers slowly
The ancient tales of our mountain land stir deep within the quiet soul.
New winds of change have swept through our valleys, altering our ways,
Leaving the wounds of time etched upon the memory of our people.

Key Poetic & Literary Vocabulary Terms:

* Meiphung : The traditional three-stone village hearth, center
* Meikha : Glowing coals / living warmth preserved overnight
* Mei-tahak : To kindle and feed the ancestral fire with seasone

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